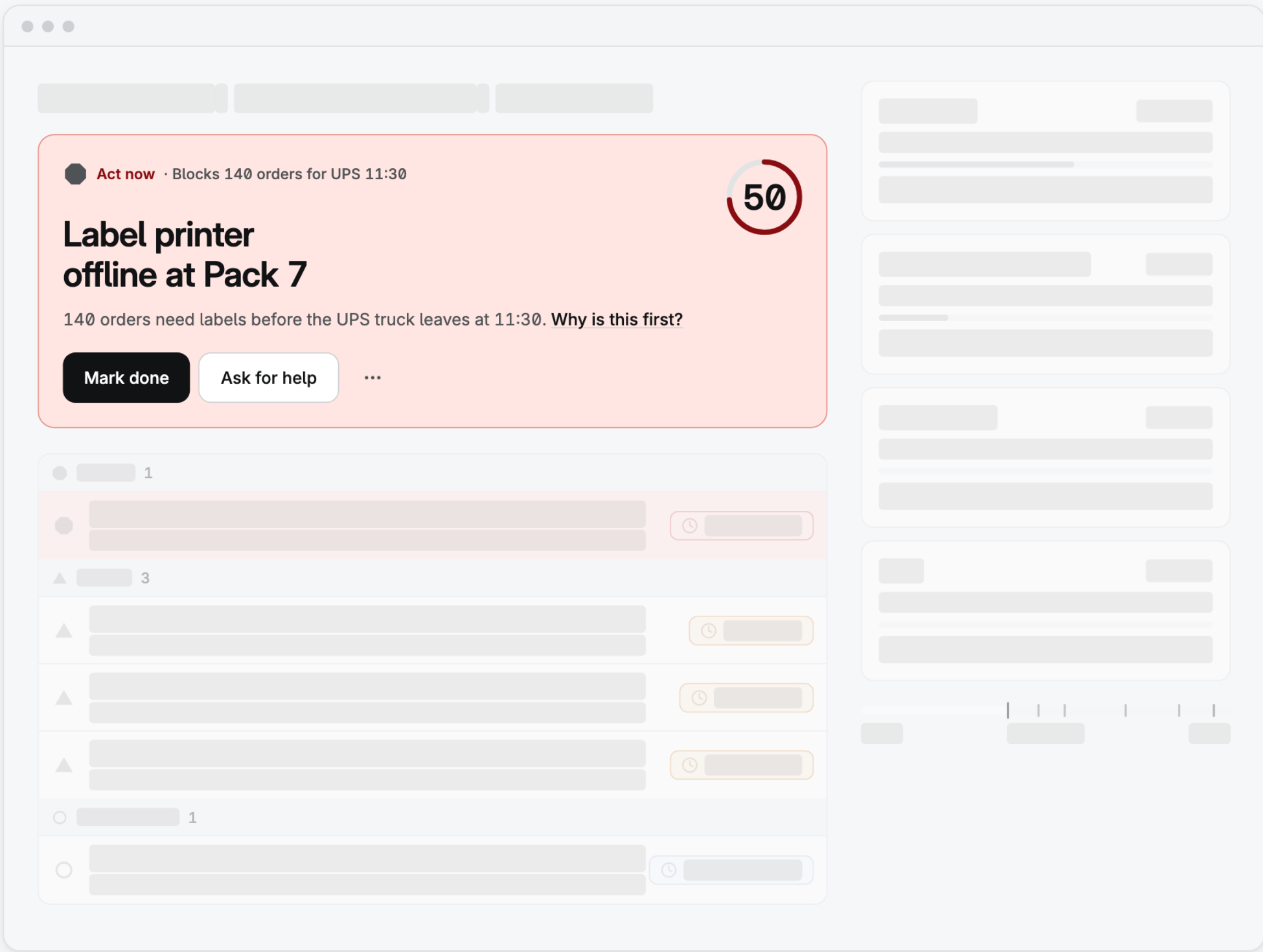


Relay

Making the **next right action obvious** — for the people doing the work, and the people leading it.

Foundey Senior Product Designer challenge · September 2026



The one hour answer

People don't need a longer list. They need to know **what to do first, and why** — and managers need to see **where to step in**, never a stopwatch on a person.

SLIDES 1-10

Two complaints, one screen

The brief: redesign the dashboard. People should see **which work comes first**, from most critical to least urgent.

"I never know what needs my attention first."

WORKERS

"I cannot see what each worker is doing."

MANAGERS

It already ranks, and that's not the fix

The current screen already has a queue titled "Needs Your Attention, ranked by urgency." People still complain, so **ranking was never the missing piece.**

WHAT WAS MISSING

1	Why	It ranks, but never says why.
2	Consequence	It groups by source, not by what happens next.
3	One first thing	Every row asks for attention at once.
4	A finish line	There is no way to be done.
5	A manager view	There is no manager surface at all.

Five failures, five fixes

THE SCREEN TODAY		RELAY
1	Ranks, but never says why	A cause line on every row, and a “Why is this first?” explainer that shows the score.
2	Labels by source, not consequence	Three groups named by time: Act now, Up next, When you can.
3	Every row carries equal weight	Rows are quiet. One hero carries the one visible action, and loudness follows rank.
4	No finish line	A done count, an undo toast, and a calm all-clear screen.
5	No manager surface at all	A Team screen: Needs you first, then a quiet table of people.

Assumptions

Three things we took as given, so the hour went into the screen **and not into the setup.**

01 · DISTANCE

Two meters, one desk

Read from about two meters, on a shared screen. Three things must work at that distance: the hero title, the countdown, and which group a row is in.

02 · PEOPLE

Two personas

A coordinator doing the work and a manager watching the floor cover the ask. Both open the same app.

03 · THE RULE

The rule is already right

The priority formula and the seed data are tested and easy to explain. The job is execution, not a new model.

What we prioritized

Craft before features: **a quiet shell** where the one thing that matters is the loudest thing.

01 · RESTRAINT

Hue only means something

Near-monochrome. Color shows priority and success, so the ranking still reads with the color taken out. Eye candy is two moments and one texture.

02 · MODES

Light, dark and wire

Three real token sets. Wire is not a filter. It is the low-fidelity deliverable, and it switches on in the live product.

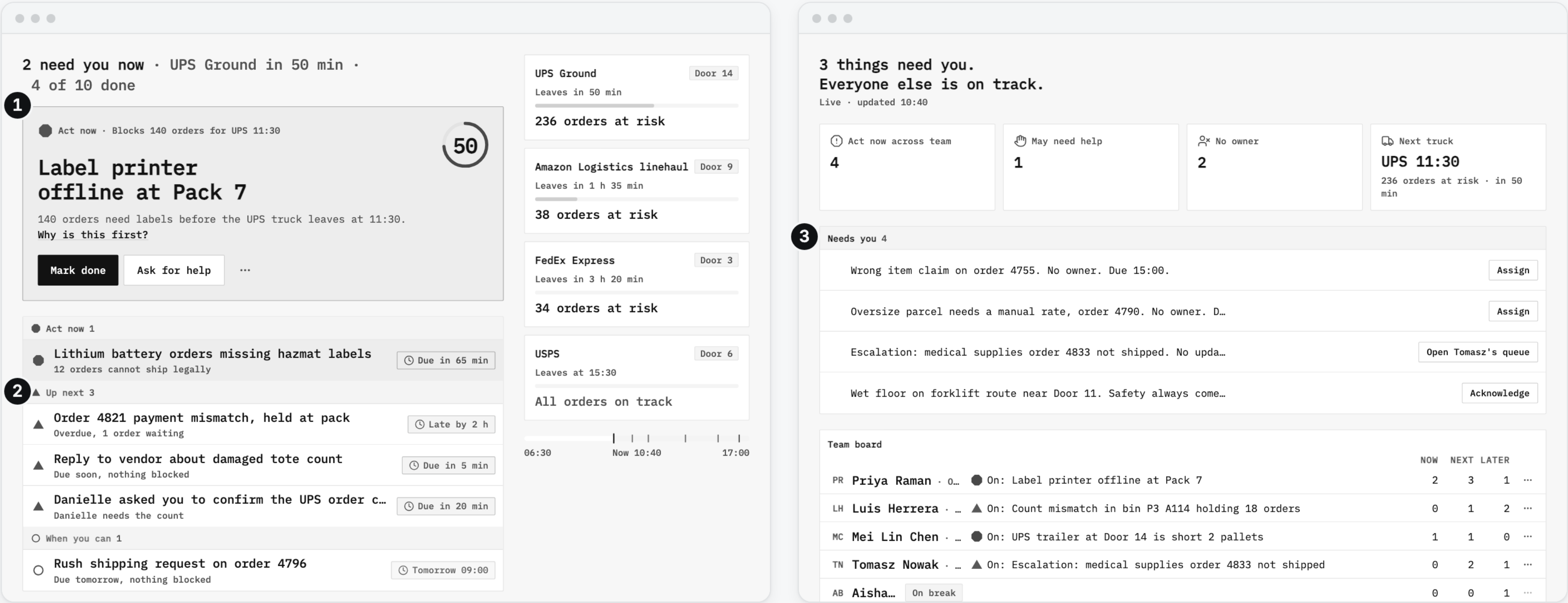
03 · ONE SOURCE

The app is the source

The app, its design system and this deck share components. Nothing here is redrawn by hand.

The wireframe

The brief asked for low fidelity. This is the real product with the **color removed**, not boxes labeled “Nav”.



- 1 Same hero with the color removed. Size and position alone say this is the one thing.

2 Rank survives as shape and fill: a disc, a triangle, a ring. Only Act now is tinted.

3 Manager view: Needs you first, each row with one specific action, then a quiet roster.

The priority rule, in one screen

Time plus orders blocked plus impact. **One score, one sort,** the same rule for every item.

40

TIME
Up to 40 points, most when late

30

ORDERS BLOCKED
Up to 30 points, at 200 or more

87

IMPACT
Up to 87 points, safety alone is 50

A score of 60 or more is Act now, and 30 or more is Up next. Safety is always Act now.

Why is this first?

TIME 30 of 40
It must be ready for the UPS Ground truck at 11:30.

ORDERS BLOCKED 22 of 30
140 orders are waiting on it.

IMPACT 10 of 87
Customers will feel it.

Time 30 + Orders 22 + Impact 10 = 62
62, 60 or higher, means Act now.
Ranks above Order 4821 payment mismatch, held at pack because it scores higher (62 to 50).

What we cut

Real ideas, **left out of the hour** on purpose. This deck went from 27 slides to 16 for the same reason.

01 · BACKEND

A real backend

State is seeded and lives in the browser. Sync, sign-in and notifications are the next project, not the next hour.

02 · PEOPLE

A third persona

Coordinator and manager cover the brief. A shift lead or a driver view is real work, and separate.

03 · HANDOFF

The shift-end handoff

A 16:30 list of what is still open, passed to the next shift in one action. Left as an idea, not built.

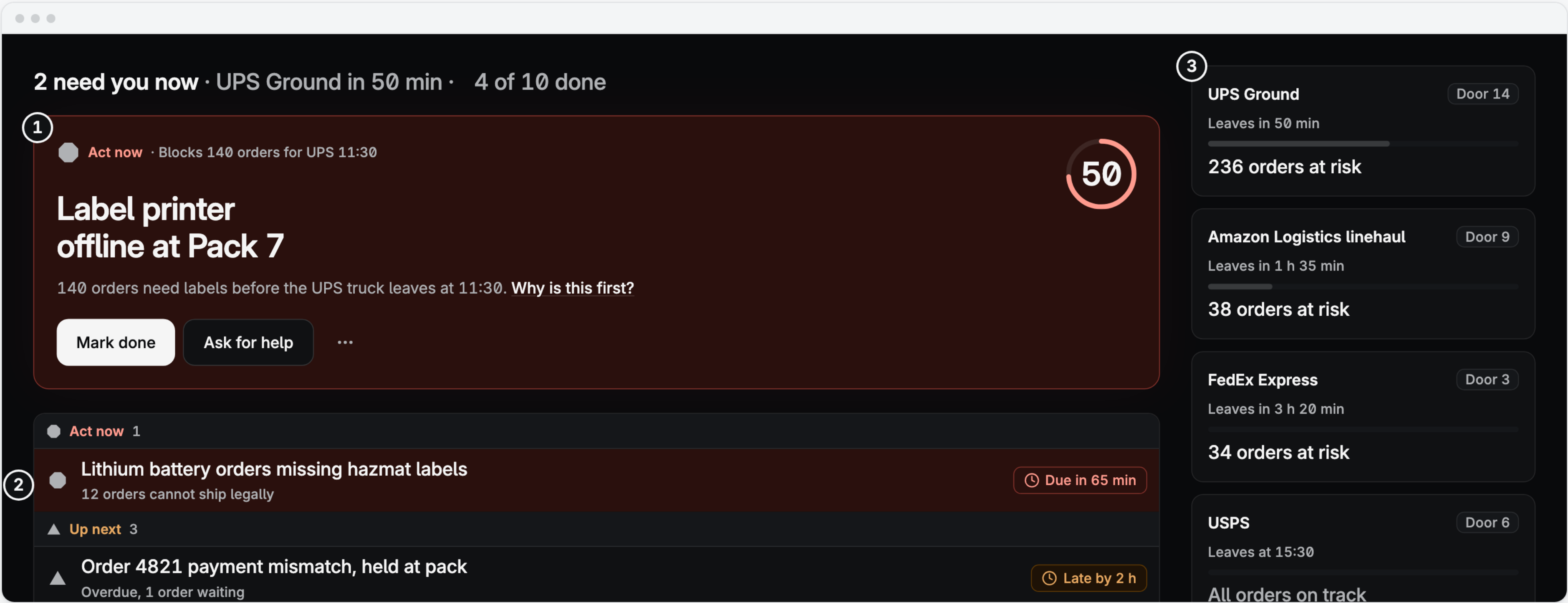
Beyond the hour

Everything from here on is **optional**. The one hour answer is complete without it.

SLIDES 11–16 · OPTIONAL

The hi-fi product

Same screen, same rule, **finished**. Type, geometry and motion now do the work that color usually does.



- 1 One object owns the page: the hero says what to do now, why, and how long.
- 2 Act now is the only tinted group. Up next and When you can are quieter, by rank.
- 3 The rail is reference: a truck clock and the shift. Nothing in it is clickable.

Motion

Eighteen named moments, one rule: **show where something went**. Nothing loops except the all-clear aurora, and nothing pulses.

≈700

MILLISECONDS, MARK DONE, END TO END

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1 | The check draws. |
| 2 | The hero leaves. |
| 3 | The next row lifts out of the list and becomes the hero. |
| 4 | The gap closes. |
| 5 | The counter rolls. |
| 6 | The toast arrives. |

Each moment also has a version for people who turn motion off. Replay them all at `/system/motion`.

The manager view, and the line it doesn't cross

A per-person stopwatch reads as surveillance, not help. The board **never times a person**, only an item.

- 1

Needs you comes first. Each row has one action with a specific verb.
- 2

The roster has no action buttons, only one quiet menu per row. A row opens the person's sheet.
- 3

No clock next to a name. Time appears on an item, and only when it signals a problem.

3 things need you. Everyone else is on track.

Live · updated 10:40

🚨 Act now across team

4

🙋 May need help

1

👤 No owner

2

🚚 Next truck

UPS 11:30

236 orders at risk · in 50 min

Needs you 4

1

Wrong item claim on order 4755. No owner. Due 15:00.

Assign

Oversize parcel needs a manual rate, order 4790. No owner. Due 11:20.

Assign

Escalation: medical supplies order 4833 not shipped. No update for 80 min.

Open Tomasz's queue

Wet floor on forklift route near Door 11. Safety always comes first.

Acknowledge

Team board

			NOW	NEXT	LATER	
3	PR	Priya Raman · Outbo...	On: Label printer offline at Pack 7	2	3	1 2
	LH	Luis Herrera · Invent...	On: Count mismatch in bin P3 A114 holding 18 orders	0	1	2 ...
	MC	Mei Lin Chen · Trans...	On: UPS trailer at Door 14 is short 2 pallets	1	1	0 ...
	TN	Tomasz Nowak · Cu...	On: Escalation: medical supplies order 4833 not shipped	0	2	1 ...
	AB	Aisha B...	On break	0	0	1 ...

Relay · Foundey challenge

14 / 16

Accessibility

Three gates that **fail the build**, not a checklist read once at the end.

G4

CONTRAST AND AXE

Zero violations, in every mode

Every route is scanned with axe in light, dark and wire. Text contrast is measured from real styles, not by eye.

G5

THE WIRE TEST

Rank survives with no hue

With color removed, the four groups still differ by shape, fill and position. No CSS filter is used anywhere.

G6

REDUCED MOTION

Every animation has a variant

The color cue stays and the movement goes. Only the all-clear aurora loops, and under reduced motion it holds still.

Next steps

The screens are built. What is left is **proving they work on a real floor.**

01 · PILOT

Run one shift

Time the first action on the floor. That is the number the three-second test stands in for.

02 · HANDOFF

Build the shift-end handoff

The 16:30 list: what is still open, passed to the next shift in one action.

03 · REAL DATA

Connect the real queue

Swap the seed for live data, sign-in, and the notifications that go with them.